Out of Control

By Mary Krell-Oishi

(BILL and MARY give their points of view about their breakup. Note: All ". . . " mean the characters pick up the line before the end of the preceding sentence.)

BILL and MARY: **(Pg 113-122)** There was nothing I could do. You don't understand. You weren't there.

MARY: He was out of control. . .

BILL: She was out of control. . .

MARY: He was like a crazy man. I was truly frightened. . .

BILL: Frightening. That's the only word I can think of. She came at me like a crazy woman. . .

MARY: The guy is crazy.

INTRODUCTION

ACTOR: *Alarming numbers of teens experience and accept abusive behavior in dating relationships. Many teens also feel physically and sexually threatened.*

ACTRESS: *1 in 5 teens who have been in a serious relationship report being hit, slapped or pushed by a partner.*

ACTOR: *Dating abuse can happen to anyone, at any age, no matter what race or religion they are, and no matter what their level of education or economical background.*

ACTRESS: *Dating abuse isn't an argument every once in a while, or a bad mood after a bad day. Dating abuse is a pattern of controlling behavior that someone uses against a girlfriend or boyfriend.*

ACTOR: *Abuse can cause injury and even death, but it doesn't have to be physical. It can include verbal and emotional abuse - constant insults, isolation from family and friends, name calling, controlling what someone wears-and it can also include sexual abuse.*

TOGETHER*: Out of Control by Mary Krell-Oishi*

BILL: I just went to see how she was; I was concerned. Hey, we were together for a long time. It's natural. . .

MARY: It's unnatural. He was checking up on me. He always did. He never trusted me. That's why I broke it off with him. . .

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BILL: I broke it off with her. She said she couldn't trust me. I don't know where that came from. But I wanted to make sure she was OK.

MARY: He was OK at first. Then, jeez, all hell broke loose. He came over about ten o'clock that morning. . .

BILL: I went over about ten o'clock that morning. She was alone. . .

MARY: I was alone.

BILL and MARY: That made me a little nervous. . .

MARY: Being alone with him, I mean. . .

BILL: I mean, I never knew what to expect. . .

MARY: The whole thing was completely unexpected. . .

BILL: I just wanted to see how she was. . .

MARY: I was sitting on the chair, reading a book and there was a knock at the door. *(Her version of the scene begins.)*

BILL: Anybody home?

MARY: *(Quietly)* Oh, shit. *(Out loud)* Just a minute. (*She lets him in.)* Hey, how you doin'?

BILL: Are you alone?

MARY: Uh. Yeah. But my parents will be back soon.

BILL: Oh, yeah? I heard they were on vacation in Mexico.

MARY: Oh. Yeah, well, they might be coming home early.

BILL: Uh-huh. So, can I sit?

MARY: Sure. I guess. Really, though, you can't stay long.

BILL: No?

MARY: No. See, I really shouldn't have anyone here without my parents being home. So. . .

BILL: So? I have to leave soon? Is that what you're saying?

MARY: Well, yes, I guess it is.

BILL: Are you expecting someone else?

MARY: No, I'm not.

BILL: So, you're here. Alone. Not waiting for anyone?

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MARY: Please leave.

BILL: Since when do you tell me when to come and when to go?

MARY: Bill, I think you should leave now.

BILL: Do you? Do you really?

MARY: Come on, Bill, Just go.

BILL: I'll go when I'm ready. And I'm not ready. So watch your mouth. Don't tell me what to do. I never liked when you told me what to do. Never. Or don't you remember that?

MARY: I know, Bill,

BILL: I don't think you do. Maybe you need a little reminder, huh? *(He crosses to her threateningly, then freezes.)*

MARY: *(Coming out of the scene)* It was always like that. He was always trying to control me, threatening me, grabbing me. *(She moves back into the scene.)*

BILL: *(Coming out of the scene)* She had called me a couple days before and sounded down, so I just wanted to say hi. I mean, I'm not a complete ass. I was concerned. So I went over there. She seemed happy to see me at first. *(He moves back into the scene.)*

MARY: *(Hugging him)* Bill, Hi.

BILL: *(Hugging back, but being the first to pull away)* Hey, you OK?

MARY: I am now that you're here.

BILL: I just wanted to say hi, see how you were.

MARY: I'm glad you're here. Stay a while.

BILL: I can't stay long.

MARY: My parents aren't here. I don't expect them back for days. They're out of the country. You can stay as long as you like.

BILL: Oh. Well. So, you doing all right?

MARY: Yeah. Sort of. You want to sit down with me on the couch?

BILL: No. Really, I can only stay a minute.

MARY: Why? No one is here except us. Just us, alone.

BILL: Yeah. Alone.

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MARY: Don't you want to be alone with me?

BILL: It's OK. It's fine. Really. Not a problem. So what have you been doing?

MARY: Doing? You mean since you broke up with me? Since you tore my heart out and threw it on the ground?

BILL: I guess. Yeah. Uh. . .

MARY: Nothing. I've been doing nothing. Eating, watching TV, waiting, hoping for the phone to ring. . . *(She goes to him; he freezes.)*

BILL: *(Coming out of the scene)* It was so obvious she wasn't over me. . .

MARY: *(Coming out of the scene)* It was so obvious he wasn't over me. . .

BILL: She looked so pathetic. . .

MARY: He looked so angry. . .

BILL: So out of it. . .

MARY: So lost. . .

BILL and **MARY:** I actually felt sorry about the whole situation. . .

MARY: Then he grabbed me. *(She goes back into her version of the scene.)* What are you doing?

BILL: I'm not doing anything I haven't done before.

MARY: Listen, Bill, that was before. You have no right to touch me, now or ever.

BILL: I told you before, don't tell me what to do.

MARY: I'm simply asking you to keep your hands off me.

BILL: Since when? Since when do you tell guys to keep their hands off you? You think I didn't hear about you and David? Did you think I'd never hear about it? You can't humiliate me like that and think nothing will happen.

MARY: What I do now is none of your business. We broke up. Get over it.

BILL: You bitch. You really imagine I can get over us? I never will. You belong to me, now and forever. *(He goes to grab her and freezes.)*

MARY: *(Coming out of the scene)* I knew I was in big trouble. . .

BILL: *(Coming out of the scene)* Trouble. The girl is trouble.

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MARY: He was grabbing me, touching me; it made my skin crawl.

BILL: She couldn't keep her hands off me. Every ime I moved away from her, she'd follow me, holding me. It was freaking me out. I couldn't get away from her.

MARY: *(Back in Bill's version)* The phone never rang. But now you're here and everything will be OK. Won't it?

BILL: Listen, Mary. We broke up. You need to get over it. Move on.

MARY: Oh, like you have? I heard about you and Caroline. Did you think I wouldn't? Did you think I'd do nothing about it? You can't humiliate me like that and think nothing will happen?

BILL: What I do now is none of your business. We broke up. Get over it.

MARY: You bastard. You really imagine I can get over us? I never will. You belong to me, now and forever. *(She goes to grab him and freezes.)*

BILL: It was always that way with her. . .

MARY: He was always like that. . .

BILL: Accusations. . .

MARY: Insinuations. . .

BILL: Constant little remarks. . .

MARY: Little remarks that always sounded like a threat. . .

BILL: A threat. I never knew what she'd do. . .

MARY: He'd do the most bizarre things. . .

BILL: Things that didn't make sense. . .

MARY: Ever since I broke up with him, he's been weird, scary weird. . .

BILL: Ever since I broke up with her, it's scary, how she is. It's hard to explain. . .

MARY: I can't explain it.

BILL: *(Back in MARY's version)* I'll never let you go. You know that, don't you? Never.

MARY: Bill, I don't know what you expect from me. We were together a long time and our relationship ended. You knew it would. I couldn't allow myself to be treated the way you were treating me.

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BILL: I treated you how you deserved to be treated. You asked for it.

MARY: I asked for it? Are you insane? No one asks to be treated like a possession, a thing. I wanted respect and I got abuse.

BILL: I respect people who deserve it. You were a lying, cheating, little slut.

MARY: I never cheated on you. Ever!

BILL: Lying bitch. *(He freezes in mid-slap.)*

MARY: *(She comes out of the scene.)* That's how it was - name calling, accusations - then it started into physical abuse. . .

BILL: *(Coming out of the scene)* The abuse took me by surprise. I mean, what's a guy supposed to do? I've never hit a girl in my life, but when you start getting hit, after awhile you have to defend yourself, right?

MARY: I never did anything. . .

BILL: Nothing would have made me. . .

MARY: He thought it was fine to take any action. . .

BILL: Actions speak louder than words. . . *(He goes back into his version of the scene.)*

MARY: Why are you here?! Did you come to make me feel worse than I already do? Do you get some sort of perverted pleasure in torturing me?

BILL: Mary, come on. We were together a long time. I'm concerned. I still have some feelings for you.

MARY: Do you? You still have feelings for me?

BILL: I would for anyone I cared about.

MARY: You still care about me?

BILL: Like any friend.

MARY: Friend! Friend! Don't do me any favors. I have all the friends I need.

BILL: I think I better go.

MARY: Fine, get out. *(She shoves him.)* Go! You son of a bitch. Bastard. *(She slaps at him, connecting.)*

BILL: *(Fending off MARY's physical attack)* Hey! That's enough. *(He grabs her arms.)* Stop!

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MARY: *(Grabbing his arms, also)* Stop! *(They both freeze.)*

BILL: I told her to stop, but she wouldn't.

MARY: He wouldn't. He wouldn't stop. I didn't know what to do. . .

BILL: What would you do? Just stand there?

MARY: He's bigger and stronger. . .

BILL: She's stronger than she looks. . .

MARY: He grabbed my hands, I couldn't move. . .

BILL: I had to hold her so she couldn't move. . .

MARY: I was so scared. . .

BILL: I was so scared. . .

MARY: It had never been like this before. . .

BILL: Before it had been just her slapping, but now she was, going crazy.

MARY: He was crazy. He pinned me down. . .

BILL: She fell down. . .

MARY: I grabbed whatever I could find. . .

BILL: I felt something hit me on the head. . .

MARY: I hit him on the head. . .

BILL: Things went black, just for a second. . .

MARY: I couldn't see what I was doing.

BILL: Then there was blood in my eyes. . .

MARY: Then his blood fell on my face. . .

BILL: I had to let her go. . .

MARY: He let me go, just for a second. . .

BILL: She got up. . .

MARY: I got up and tried to get away. . .

BILL: She moved. . .

MARY: He grabbed my leg. . .

BILL: I tried to get up. . .

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MARY: I fell back against the table. . .

BILL: I couldn't get up. . .

MARY: It was like a slow-motion movie. . .

BILL: Everything just slowed down. Got blurry. . .

MARY: It's all a blur. I hit the table. . .

BILL: I heard a crack on the table. . .

MARY: My head. . .

BILL: Everything was dark. . .

MARY: I could feel the warm sticky blood. . .

BILL: My blood. . .

MARY: My blood. . .

BILL: There was the loud rushing sound of waves. . .

MARY: Waves of nausea. . .

BILL: Waves of fear. . .

MARY: I looked over at him. . .

BILL: I saw her. . .

MARY: Bleeding. . .

BILL: Bleeding. . .

MARY: How did we get here?

BILL: How did this happen?

MARY: I looked and then stared. . .

BILL: I stared. . .

MARY and BILL: And then there was nothing.

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AWARD HISTORY

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